

one operating system installed, select Multi-boot. TrueCrypt is cross platform, so the same method can be used from a Linux Operating System to encrypt and password protect a Windows installation on the same machine. Note that, in case of multi-boot, the other Operating System need not be located on the same hard drive as the one being encrypted, this option is just so that the TrueCrypt bootloader is configured correctly.

The next step is to choose the encryption algorithm. Choose an cipher, and click on Next. Then, key in a password. If you choose to use a keyfile at this point of time, the keyfile will have to be selected before system load from an external device. This means that every time the Operating System has to be booted, there has to be a USB drive plugged in to the system. This is very secure, but if you lose the keyfile, you will lose access to your data as well.

The next step generates encryption keys using random data. Just move the mouse randomly for some time, and click on next. The next window allows you to create a rescue disc in case you lose your keyfile. This operation basically allows you to restore the system to the current state. This is necessary in case your keyfile gets corrupt, the bootloader gets corrupt, or the Windows installation becomes unusable or infected by malware. The rescue disc is an iso image that must be burned on, which is a bootable disk. Burn the iso image before proceeding with the encryption. Don't burn the image on the DVD itself, but burn the files inside the iso, that is open the iso file using a DVD burning software, and proceed.

You will have to burn the disc, put it in the tray, and click on **Customize the bootloader**. Click on Next.

You get to customize the bootloader now. Enter some text for the password prompt. This can be anything that you prefer. Click on Next, and the encryption process starts. This will take some time. The next time you boot the operating system, you will be prompted for a password.

5.5 Securely format drives

Sometimes, it is important to delete data. This can range from sensitive documents to keyfiles. The ability to erase securely is more important when using public computers, or shared computers. Also, if you are selling away old hard disks, it is